

Sabah Nushra

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✉ Sabah Nushra | 🐱 Meowthhh | 🌐 Meowthhh

Dhaka 1207, Bangladesh

Education

Islamic University of Technology (IUT)

B.Sc. in Computer Science and Engineering

GPA: 3.25/4.00

Jan 2020 – Jun 2024

Dhaka, Bangladesh

Research Interests

Computer Vision; Multimodal & Vision-Language Models; Trustworthy AI; Model Evaluation; Distribution Shift; Uncertainty & Calibration; Test-Time Adaptation; Low-Resource & Multilingual AI

Research Experience

ELITE Research Lab LLC

Research Intern

Jan 2026 – Present

- Conducted research on trustworthy AI, multimodal and vision-language model evaluation, cross-dataset generalization, uncertainty-aware evaluation, and model reliability across computer vision, medical imaging, and language-model applications.
- Designed reproducible benchmarking pipelines for calibration, selective prediction, distribution shift, dataset leakage and provenance auditing, robustness analysis, and systematic model failure evaluation.

Research Papers

Do Open Language Models Invent Scripture? BILAL-BENCH: Benchmarking Islamic-Source Fabrication in Bengali

Accepted, Muslims in ML Workshop at NeurIPS 2026 / First Author

- Introduced *BILAL-BENCH*, a 240-question expert-verified Bengali benchmark across five categories, and evaluated seven open-weight models on 1,680 double-annotated responses.
- Found 79.3–95.3% confident fabrication for six of seven models on source-production questions; only 2 of 315 Hadith responses were both correct and correctly sourced, with no consistent scale trend.

Knowing When Not to Answer: Image-Grounded Answerability and Abstention in Medical VQA

Under Review, NAACL 2027 / First Author

- Constructed a 45,942-pair medical VQA benchmark of answerable and unanswerable questions across X-ray, MRI, CT, histology, and gross pathology.
- Developed an answerability-aware framework using question-to-statement transformation, BioMedCLIP alignment, and learned projections to enable abstention on visually unsupported questions.

What Does Cross-Dataset Generalization Really Measure? A Dataset-Integrity Study in Brain Tumor MRI

Manuscript in Preparation / Lead Researcher

- Conducted a systematic cross-dataset study of eight CNN, Transformer, and foundation-model architectures across three public brain MRI datasets to assess the reliability of external generalization under dataset shift.
- Audited dataset provenance, exact and perceptual overlap, and split leakage, supported by multi-seed evaluation and $1,000\times$ bootstrap resampling to determine how hidden dataset relatedness can confound apparent generalization.

Understanding How Vision Models Fail: A Graph-Based Framework for Severity, Stability, and Model Complementarity

Manuscript in Preparation / Lead Researcher

- Developed a graph-based evaluation framework to characterize how vision models fail by capturing the frequency, severity, and structural patterns of class-level prediction errors.
- Developed *Failure Graph Risk (FGR)* from failure frequency, confidence, semantic distance, and sample difficulty, with analyses of stability and model complementarity.

Beyond the Leaderboard: Reliability-Aware Operating-Point Evaluation for Bangla Cyberbullying Moderation

Manuscript in Preparation / Lead Researcher

- Evaluated Bangla-specific, multilingual, and compact generative models on 43,147 cleaned comments under a frozen train-development-test protocol for five-class cyberbullying moderation.
- Analyzed calibration, selective prediction, rare-class Threat behavior, realistic Bangla perturbations, human errors, and compute cost; the calibrated ensemble achieved Macro-F1 0.8547 and Risk@90 0.0973.

Academic Service

Reviewer, Muslims in ML Workshop at NeurIPS 2026

Selected Projects

Seeing Isn't Structuring

2026

Python, PyTorch, Hugging Face, Jupyter/Kaggle



- Developed a controlled 170-query multimodal benchmark across seven failure modes, with synthetic Snakes & Ladders generation, prerequisite calibration, automated scoring, and cross-model evaluation of seven open-weight VLMs to identify systematic failures in structured visual reasoning beyond basic perception.

Darkroom: Old Photo Restoration and Colorization

2026

Python, PyTorch, OpenCV, Gradio, Hugging Face



- Built an end-to-end restoration and colorization pipeline combining denoising, scratch removal, contrast enhancement, and transfer-learned colorization, improving PSNR from 15.28 to 16.84 and SSIM from 0.282 to 0.487 on synthetically degraded test images.

ML Algorithm Visualizer

2024

Jupyter, scikit-learn



- Developed educational software that visually demonstrates the working processes of core machine-learning algorithms, including Linear and Logistic Regression, Neural Networks, SVMs, K-means, Naive Bayes, Decision Trees, and PCA, to make fundamental concepts easier to understand through visual learning.

Helmet Detection using YOLO

2023

Python, OpenCV, YOLOv5/YOLOv6/YOLOv8



- Developed a web application to detect whether motorcycle riders are wearing helmets, comparing YOLOv5, YOLOv6, and YOLOv8 on the project dataset for automated road-safety monitoring.

Additional Experience

Beetles Cyber Security Ltd.

Aug 2024 – Dec 2024

Cybersecurity Engineer

Dhaka, Bangladesh

- Assisted with day-to-day security monitoring, alert triage, and vulnerability scanning across systems and network assets, escalating suspicious activity and potential incidents to senior team members.
- Supported basic system and network hardening, remediation follow-up, access-control checks, and security documentation for identified vulnerabilities and incidents.

Leadership

IUT Programming Community

May 2022 – May 2024

Advisor

- Mentored students in programming, problem solving, data structures, and algorithms; organized national-level contests, workshops, problem-solving sessions, and industry-led software-development seminars.

IEEE IUT Student Branch

Feb 2022 – May 2024

Chief Public Relations Officer

- Organized workshops on machine learning, deep learning, blockchain, and research methodology; coordinated collaborations with IEEE student branches and alumni to expand technical learning and networking.

Honors & Awards

Women in Tech BD, Huawei – 1st Runner-up

2024

IUTCS “The Great Web Off” – Champion

2024

Blockchain Olympiad Bangladesh – 4th, National Rank

2024

BUET CSE Fest Deep Learning Sprint 2.0 – 32nd

2024

ASR for Regional Dialects Datathon, Bengali.AI – 30th

2023

ICPC Algo Queen – Top 60, Global Rank

2023

CodeRush 1.0 IUT Programming Contest – 9th

2023

IUT Intra-University Programming Contest – 6th

2022

Ada Lovelace National Girls' Programming Contest – 17th

2021

Technical Skills

Programming: Python, C++, Java, SQL

Tools: Git, Docker, LaTeX, Jupyter, Kaggle, Matplotlib

ML/CV: PyTorch, TensorFlow/Keras, OpenCV, scikit-learn, Hugging Face, NumPy, Pandas